

Palm Tungsten T and T2

The core business line of PDAs from Palm, the Tungsten T and T2 are sleek and feature an innovative slide-out design. Palm India doesn't retail the T, but encourages bulk buys from corporates.

Though both use the same processor and are exactly the same in terms of design and features, the T2 is the later model, running Palm OS 5.2.1; the Tungsten T runs Palm OS 5.0. This means that the T does not have Graffiti 2, Colour Themes and Writing Area—Writing Area allows you to use the entire screen as a Graffiti 2 input area. It also allows you to see pen strokes as you write, if this option is selected.

Apart from this, there is a slight difference in body colour—a gunmetal finish for the T, and metallic silver for the T2. With 32 MB of internal storage, the T2 has double the memory as compared to its predecessor, and a transreflective colour screen that's better than the original Tungsten T display.

Both PDAs weigh 159 gms, and measure 4 x 3 x 0.6 inches. Apart from the 320 x 320 colour screen, both have the circular five-way navigation key, four application buttons, a small LED on the top left and a speaker on the corresponding right side. Both have a voice recorder button and a 3.5 mm stereo jack on the left. Power buttons, expansion card slots and the IR ports are on top, while the Palm Universal Connectors are at the bottom. The spring-loaded stylus is concealed, and can be accessed by pressing the protruding end. The bottom on both the units slides out to reveal the graffiti area. If you want to access data

just by using the stylus and the buttons, you can leave the slider closed.

A clear clip-on plastic screen cover is cut out to expose the five-way navigator, so you can peruse without removing the cover. You can also press down once on the button in the centre of the navigator to display the date and time, or hold it down

to display the home screen, from which you can launch applications. The reset button now hides at the rear, and can only be accessed with the slider open.

Moreover, the wider reset access hole means that you can use the stylus tip to reset the PDA, instead of hunting for a pin or paper-clip. The build quality for both is excellent—even with the sliding design—and both PDAs feel rugged.

With Texas Instruments' OMAP1510 ARM processors running at 144 MHz, you get Bluetooth, a voice recorder, an external speaker, MP3 and video playback. The PDAs sync with a PC through the accompanying USB cradle.

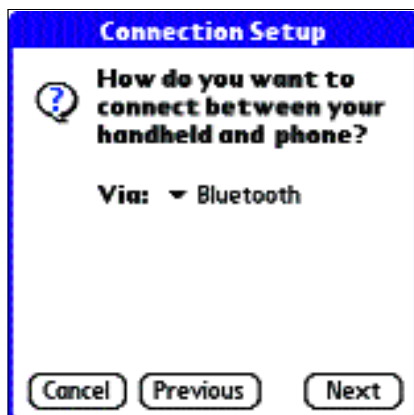
In terms of applications, both PDAs come loaded with the usual PIM applications. A generous bundle of third-party applications—Documents to Go, Chapura Pocket Mirror (for syncing with Outlook),

BlueBoard, BlueChat, Handmark's MobileDB, PowerOne Personal Calculator, Acrobat Reader for Palm, Palm Reader, Handmark's Monopoly, Handmark's Scrabble—are provided on the CD. BlueBoard lets you share ideas with up to three other Bluetooth users simultaneously, and you can chat using BlueChat. Some applications—VersaMail, Web Browser Pro, WAP Browser, Dialer and SMS—are on the CD bundled with the Tungsten T, but come pre-installed on the T2.

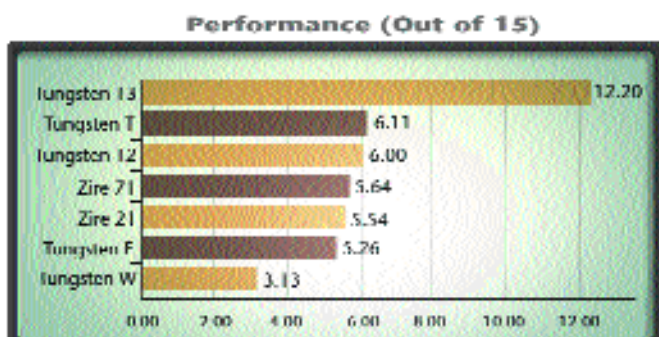
Though the Tungsten T is multimedia-capable, it does not have any applications for music or video playback. This is remedied in the T2, in the form of the RealOne Mobile Player and Kinoma Player and Producer.

3D games run without hiccups. Switching between applications, and viewing images and videos is fast. The colour screen on the T is bright and evenly lit, while that of the T2 is even better, showing better colour saturation. The speaker in front means that unlike the Zire 71, sound isn't muffled. The internal lithium polymer 900 mAH battery on the T gave us a good two hours and 37 minutes, while the T2 lasted for one hour and 55 minutes before dying out.

With features such as voice memo, Bluetooth, sliding design and multimedia capabilities, the T and T2 have a lot to offer. However, if you are a corporate executive and already own a Tungsten T, don't consider upgrading to the T2.



Pairing the Tungsten T2 with a Bluetooth-enabled mobile phone is child's play



+ Compact size
Price: Tungsten T2: Rs 21,999,
 Tungsten T: NA

Palm Tungsten T2		C+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
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